Founders: API down overnight. Who acts?

Ownership across a daily outbound run: trigger, automation, exception, human, audit trail.

OPERATIONS · 1 / 7

OWNER 1 · TRIGGER

The kill switch is read before step one.

If it is set, nothing runs and the log says why.

self_outbound_system / run.py

```
kill = env.get("KILL_SWITCH", "0").strip()
if kill == "1":
    msg = "KILL_SWITCH=1 in env — halting run.py
  immediately. No sub-steps executed."
    log.error(msg)
    print(msg)
    return 2
```

OWNER 2 · AUTOMATION

Retry with backoff, then raise.

Rate limits and server errors get MAX_RETRIES = 2 with backoff. A loop that never gives up is a hidden outage.

modules / llm_client.py

```
except RateLimitError as e:
    last_exc = e
    if attempt < MAX_RETRIES:
        delay = BASE_DELAY * (2 ** attempt)
        logger.warning("Rate limited (attempt %d/%d),
  retrying in %.1fs", …)
        time.sleep(delay)
except APIStatusError as e:
    last_exc = e
    if e.status_code ⩾ 500 and attempt < MAX_RETRIES:
        …
    else:
        raise
```

OWNER 3 · EXCEPTION

The same finding three rounds running: abort.

The audit loop fingerprints every finding. If one repeats for three consecutive rounds without a fix, it stops instead of oscillating.

anneal / src / anneal / audit / base.py

```
def finding_fingerprint(f: Finding) → str:
    """Return a stable 16-hex-char hash of (severity,
  file, summary).

    Used by the loop to detect oscillation: if the same
  fingerprint appears
    in three consecutive rounds without being fixed, the
  loop aborts.
    """
```

OWNER 4 · HUMAN

Release does not resume.

Releasing the kill switch sets it to zero and stops there. A person resumes sending and checks the canary is green first.

self_outbound_system / killswitch.py

```
description: One-shot kill switch. --engage sets
  KILL_SWITCH=1 in the workspace .env and calls
  instantly_client.py --action pause. --release sets
  KILL_SWITCH=0 but does NOT auto-resume Instantly
  (operator must resume in UI + verify canary green).
```

OWNER 5 · AUDIT TRAIL

A dated run log, one structured line per step.

So 'what happened on Tuesday' has an answer that is not a Slack thread.

self_outbound_system / run.py

```
outputs: .tmp/self_outbound/run_<date>.log — structured
  JSONL log of each step. Prints end-of-run digest to
  stdout.
```

Who in your company acts when the model is uncertain, the API fails, or a customer needs a person?